

Minutes – Cincinnati Contra Board Meeting –

April 6, 2025 7:00 pm

Present:

Valerie Allendorf, Larry Lankford, Cori Yaeger, Steve Edwards, Charles Wallner, Kurt Grannan, Josh Telecsan, Michael Hentz, Audrey Eyman, Philip Ogston, Deven Corzine, Myra Mitchell, Bonnie Carpenter

Introduction

Meeting Minutes from 03/02/25 accepted by consensus.

Treasurer's Report – accepted by consensus.

Secretary's report - nothing to report.

WFAC report – any news on contract or speaker – Josh sent details to WFAC about what they want to do with speakers – hasn't heard back.

Social Secretary Report – Bonnie sent cards to Robin (death of his mother), death of Mary Lane – card sent to family, Ray Hassard (open heart surgery). Card will be sent to Mark Barsamian on death of his wife.

Scheduling Report – Bonnie and Deven working on the next six months. Hopefully will be finished by May 1. Counter Current Band 4th Saturday of June 28. Extra Saturday Dance. Larry mentioned that Trillium is supposed to play this Saturday -but Mark had a death in the family (wife). Deven checked and Mark is looking forward to playing this Saturday.

Raven and Goose want to come Monday in October 6? Charles pointed out that next year we should have a budget for how much we want to pay for out of town bands. They want \$200, but that bumps our local groups. Philip suggested we have a pot of money for all the travel budget for each 6 months. Kurt suggests we make it a part of our recruitment and promotion. Give all the bands promotional space on our blog site.

Myra thinks we should welcome bands and callers from out of town. Audrey agrees as does Kurt. Welcome Raven and Goose for October 6.

Lots of discussion about whether we accommodate out of town bands recognizing that that bumps local bands. Philip suggests we set a budget and a limit. Charles points out that our mission gives us a balancing act between fostering local talent and expanding to out of town talent.

Deven suggests that we promote national bands – maybe having them play at a day and time different from our usual schedule.

Audrey suggested that we could have a mini-event 6 months away from PTF that uses a few bands for a longer period of time.

Valerie pointed out that we have moved from one local and one national band at PTF, to two national bands.

Philip pointed out that bringing in outside bands helps to support other dance organizations – expanding the pie.

Larry pointed out that in the past there was a formula that dictated how many local and how many out of town bands would be used in a 6 months period.

Bonnie likes having out of town guests. Bonnie pointed out that Raven and Goose want Liz Burkhardt to call. Liz hasn't called for us for over 2 years. Steve suggested that Bonnie ask if Raven and Goose can do a Saturday, rather than Monday. Then approving for a Monday. Bonnie thinks they will be okay with a caller other than Liz.

Kurt wonders if we can let bands pick their callers (R & G) wanting Liz. Charles says it is not okay for a band to dictate callers.

Old Business

Pigtown – Valerie – sent out email to participants for debriefing. Myra, Charles, and Valerie will compile the input. Looking at 2026 requiring more resources. Charles voiced appreciation to all who helped. Total 381 including a la carte. There seemed to be about 260 on the floor at any one time. Two minor injuries reported after the fact. Next year have ice and first aid kit handy. Josh commented that we need to look at the profit from PTF and have it cover the budget for the rest of the year. Philip suggested we look at a long term financial plan and see if we can invest some of the profit from PTF. Steve indicated that our out-of-town folks support PTF and our local organization. PTF for next year. Dam Beavers is playing in Columbus and Carolina Meltdown in close time proximity. But we had a verbal agreement so we will honor our agreement with Dam Beavers.

Website – Kurt has completed most of the website. Need to add ecommerce to the website. Kurt also mentioned that we might include the national page of dances as part of the website. Cori will try to get the "code" to go to Kurt also – not just to Cori.

Audrey suggested that folks can help Cori get info transferred. Then the committee can "test" the website and its functionality before we go live. Valerie wants Facebook, MailChimp, and Pigtown to integrate to the website. Kurt mentioned that we don't have to go "live" with all of it – but can get out the important stuff sooner rather than later.

Cori reminded the board that they had approved \$500-750 for the guy from Dam Beavers was thinking about helping us. He was not able to help us. We need to pay Kurt. Kurt says he will send an invoice once he feels the site is operational and input can be done by others. Board approved Kurt sending an invoice. Kurt said he had a good starting point and said that Audrey and Cori had done a good job doing the foundation for the website.

New callers – Steve suggested new callers can ask for more time. Steve is willing to give up his calling dates to new callers if they want. Audrey would like to have a callers meet-up to meet with the new callers before a dance. Beth has been organizing this.

Sara Kaiser wants to call on Monday September 15. She wants expenses. Board agreed to have Bonnie negotiate up to \$100. Philip suggests a fixed amount for travel expenses. (either standard amount or total per six months).

Google Drive progress - tabled

½ day retreat – maybe full day retreat (9am-3pm?) – three possible dates looked at for retreat (6/21; 6/28; 7/26). Our potential facilitator is open all 3 dates. Facilitator has offered to do our retreat for free (we'll pay something as she's coming from Cleveland - \$300-\$500 suggested). Audrey is going to ask this person to co-facilitate a function with her to get an idea of how she'll do.

Charles and Bonnie are handling food – budget \$350 . work 9-noon, lunch noon -1; work 1-4.

Recruiting more dancers - tabled

New Business

Vendor's permit?

Add "everybody's dance" to our liability insurance – CDSS told us we could add them. We can make it a reciprocal deal. Philip suggests it would add to the co-system (making the pie bigger.) Larry said that adding them to our policy would only cost \$175.00 per year. Larry will not be at the dance on Monday or Saturday this coming week. Philip and Kurt will handle it with help from Deven if needed.

CDSS legacy planning – Bonnie - tabled

Report from PTF Gaye Fifer meeting – Bonnie - tabled

Callers and bands – quality and scheduling - tabled

Board member roles and responsibilities -tabled

advertising for new dancers – PSAs and local publications. - tabled

Meeting ended at 9:06 pm

Next meeting: May 4, 2025, 7:00 pm zoom